

TRAN HOANG PHUONG LINH

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Department of Economics

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PLACEMENT DIRECTORS

Prof. Rui Castro rui.castro@mcgill.ca (514) 398-1226

Prof. John W Galbraith john.galbraith@mcgill.ca (514) 398-5167

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics, McGill University, Canada, expected May 2026

B.A. (Honours) Economics and Econometrics, University of Queensland, Australia, 2019

FIELDS OF SPECIALIZATION

Primary: Econometrics and Machine Learning

Secondary: Macroeconomics and Central Banking

DISSERTATION

Essays on Central Bank Communications with Textual Analysis.

Committee: Prof. John W Galbraith, Prof. Francisco Ruge-Murcia.

RESEARCH PAPERS

“Central Bank Communication in Time of Crisis: Different Aspects of Linguistic Complexity” (job market paper)

Central banks adjust their communication strategies to balance clarity and flexibility, especially amid shifting economic conditions. Textual complexity can signal deliberate ambiguity, preserving policy maneuverability while still guiding expectations. This paper uses natural language tools to analyze policy statements from multiple central banks and their relationship to textual complexity, examining not only readability but also abstractness, informativeness, and disunity. Findings show that complexity increases during periods of low growth or economic stimulus, and that messaging aimed at households and firms accounts for a significant share, underscoring the importance of effective communication with the general public. By tracing these patterns, the study deepens our understanding of how central banks communicate during crises and contributes to broader research on credibility and policy signalling.

“Deliberation and Policy Outcomes: Evidence from the FOMC,” with Francisco Ruge-Murcia and Alessandro Riboni

Natural language processing is used to extract information from FOMC transcripts and construct quantitative text-based measures of policy stance, emotions, and collaboration. These measures are inputs in [to] an econometric model of deliberation where members interact with one another across rounds of a meeting and over time across meetings. Evidence is reported that members learn from one another during within-meeting deliberation and exert influence across meetings. Although emotional tone has limited effect on policy stances and decisions, it has strong predictive power [on] for dissent behavior.

OTHER RESEARCH PAPERS

“Regulation Complexity Measurements: Methods and Patterns across Time and Industry”, 2023, unpublished manuscript

“Applied Causal Inference using Identification Robust Confidence Sets Under Sparsity”, 2019, Honours Thesis, School of Economics, The University of Queensland

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, Econometrics (graduate), McGill University, Fall 2021– Fall 2023

Teaching Assistant, Quantitative Methods (graduate), McGill University, Fall 2021, Fall 2022 and Fall 2023

Teaching Assistant, Applied Cross-Sectional Methods (graduate), McGill University, Winter 2024

Teaching Assistant, Economic Statistics (undergraduate), McGill University, Fall 2024 – Winter 2025

Teaching Assistant, Introduction to Econometrics (undergraduate), University of Queensland, 2018–2019

RESEARCH AND WORK EXPERIENCE

ML Reproducibility Challenge, Prof. Siamak Ravanbakhsh, Fall 2021

Research Assistant, Prof. Renuka Mahadeva, University of Queensland, Jul-Oct 2018

Research Assistant, Working as a Casual SRN (Student Relations Network) Crew member, Sept-Nov 2018

CIREQ Lunch Seminar presenter, 2023-2025

Participated in online competition, including Black Friday sales prediction, Big Mart sale prediction, HR analytics, Feedback Prize - English Language Learning (Evaluating language knowledge of ELL students from grades 8-12), 2018-2024

GRANTS AND AWARDS

Graduate Funding, McGill University Department of Economics

FitzGerald scholarship for Bachelor of Economics (Honour), 2019

Vietnam Undergraduate Scholarship at The School of Economics - The University of Queensland

CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

2023-2025: CIREQ Lunch Seminar presenter, 2026: CIREQ Weekly PhD Student Research Workshop (scheduled)

LANGUAGES

English (fluent), Vietnamese (native), French (beginner)

COMPUTATIONAL SKILLS

Python (highly proficient), MATLAB, Stata (Proficient), R, EViews, HTML, C++

REFERENCES

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